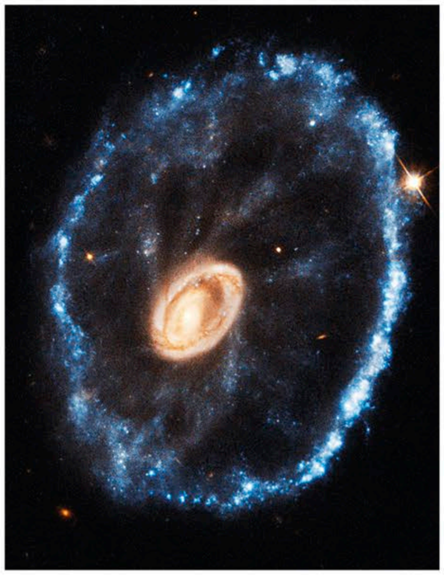


△ **ESO 350-40**
About 500 million light-years away and 150,000 light-years across, this galaxy's cartwheel shape is the result of a huge galactic collision. A smaller galaxy passed through a larger spiral, producing shock waves that swept up gas and dust. This sparked the birth of billions of stars, seen in blue in the outer ring.

CAELUM
THE CHISEL

SMALL AND INSIGNIFICANT, CAELUM IS FORMED FROM TWO FAINT STARS THAT, LINKED TOGETHER, REPRESENT AN ENGRAVER'S CHISEL.

One of the smallest constellations in the southern sky, Caelum lies between Eridanus and Columba. It was one of the 14 introduced by French astronomer Nicolas Louis de Lacaille in 1754. Caelum's size and position away from the plane of the Milky Way mean that it has few deep-sky objects so its stars are the main objects of interest. Of them, only Alpha, Beta, and Gamma are brighter than magnitude 5.

KEY DATA

Size ranking 81

Brightest stars Alpha (α) 4.5, Beta (β) 5.0

Genitive Caeli

Abbreviation Cae

Highest in sky at 10pm December–January

Fully visible 41°N–90°S

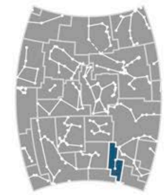


CHART 6

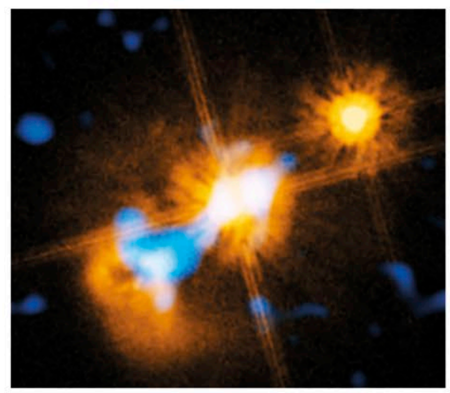
MAIN STARS

Alpha (α) Caeli
White main-sequence star, and a binary star
4.5 ⟷ 66 light-years

Beta (β) Caeli
White subgiant star
5.0 ⟷ 93 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

Quasar HE0450-2958
Quasar, also classed as a Seyfert galaxy



△ **Quasar HE 0450-2958**
Located toward the north of the constellation, quasar HE0450-2958 is unusual in that its host galaxy is too faint to be seen directly because it is swamped by the quasar's light. This composite image of it is made up of an infrared image from ESO's Very Large Telescope and a visible-light image from the Hubble Space Telescope.